BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #27 · GENETICS AND FAMILY HISTORY

"I'll end up just like my parent."

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Where it often comes from

Seeing a parent struggle with addiction, anger, depression, or illness, we may be terrified of repeating their path. Others tell us, "You're just like your father," and we may start acting as if the script is already written.

What Scripture teaches

"The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son." "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17). "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind" (Romans 12:2). You can learn from a parent's pain what to avoid. Your life is your own to live with God's help.

> *"The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him"* (Ezekiel 18:20).

Also see

> "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!" (2 Corinthians 5:17).

> "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God" (Romans 12:2).

> "Fathers shall not be put to death for their children, nor children for their fathers; each is to die for his own sin" (Deuteronomy 24:16).

> "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope" (Jeremiah 29:11).

Common self-statements

- I am just like them.
- I cannot escape their pattern.
- I will make the same mistakes.
- It is in my nature.
- People expect me to turn out like them.
- I am destined to repeat it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either unlike my parent or identical.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will repeat their life.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling the pull and concluding it is inevitable.
- Labeling: Calling myself a copy.

Challenging questions

- In what ways am I different from my parent?
- What did my parent lack that I can have?
- What exactly do I fear repeating?
- What choices can I make differently?
- Who could support me, like a counselor, mentor, or pastor?
- What does Scripture say about being a new creation?

Truth summary

> I am not my parent. I am a new creation in Christ, and I can choose differently, learn from their story, and receive support. My life is not a repeat.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Fear
- Parenting
- Hopeless
- Forgiveness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Death and Dying

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'll end up just like my parent"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'll end up just like my parent." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ In what ways am I different from my parent?
- ☐ What did my parent lack that I can have?
- ☐ What exactly do I fear repeating?
- ☐ What choices can I make differently?
- ☐ Who could support me, like a counselor, mentor, or pastor?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about being a new creation?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am a new creation.
- ☐ The son does not bear the father's iniquity.
- ☐ My mind can be renewed.
- ☐ I can choose differently.
- ☐ Support is available.
- ☐ God has a future for me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ezekiel 18:20
  "The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 5:17
  "Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old has passed away. Behold, the new has come!"
- ☐ Romans 12:2
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A different path: Each week, note one choice that differs from the pattern.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Ezekiel 18:20 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am a new creation in Christ.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Thinking, Unhealthy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List differences. Write how you are not like your parent.
- ☐ Name the fear. Write what you want to avoid.
- ☐ Make a plan. Choose one concrete safeguard.
- ☐ Find support. Counseling or a mentor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'll end up just like my parent": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A different path
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'll end up just like my parent.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear repeating the past. Make me new, give me wisdom to choose differently, and surround me with support. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.